

IELTS Listening Section 1: Answer-Finding Signals & Hint Words

® Moving from One Question to Another (Filler Words)

Speakers use **filler words** before giving important details.

✓ Examples:

- *Right, great, okay, so, well, now, let's move on*
📌 **Example in audio:**
“Okay, now let's talk about your booking details.”
🔥 **Tip:** The answer comes **right after** this phrase!
-

® Ordering & Numbering (Sequence Words)

Numbers help you **track the flow of conversation**.

✓ Examples:

- *First, second, next, then, after that, finally, lastly*
📌 **Example in audio:**
“First, you need to register. Then, you must pay the fee.”
🔥 **Tip:** The first answer is likely **after "First"**!
-

® Emphasis Signals

When speakers emphasize something, it's **usually important**.

✓ Examples:

- *What I decided to do was...*
- *The most important thing is...*
📌 **Example in audio:**
“The most important thing is to arrive before 10 AM.”
🔥 **Answer:** Arrive before 10 AM

® Direct Questions in the Recording

Whenever a speaker asks a question, **the next phrase often contains the answer.**

✅ Examples:

- *Who will...? Where is...? How much...?*
📌 **Example in audio:**
"Where is the meeting?" → "At the City Hall."
🔥 **Answer: City Hall**

® Positive & Negative Contrast

When a speaker changes their mind, **the second part usually has the correct answer.**

✅ Examples:

- *That's good, but... / It seems fine, except... / The only issue is...*
📌 **Example in audio:**
"The hotel is nice, but it's quite expensive."
🔥 **Answer: Expensive**

® Negative Tone

When speakers say **bad news**, the answer often follows.

✅ Examples:

- *I'm afraid... / Unfortunately... / I don't think so...*
📌 **Example in audio:**
"I'm afraid the class is full."
🔥 **Answer: Class is full**

® Answer Stressed in Final Words

Key details are often **repeated at the end.**

 Example in audio:

"The ticket normally costs \$20, but with a discount, it's \$15."

 **Answer: \$15**

® **Suggestions & Advice**

People often suggest **what needs to be done**.

 Examples:

- *You really need to... / You should... / You must...*

 Example in audio:

"You really need to bring your passport for the test."

 **Answer: Bring passport**

® **New Topics Introduced (Transition Words)**

When a speaker introduces a **new point**, answers usually follow.

 Examples:

- *As regards... / Speaking of... / Concerning...*

 Example in audio:

"As regards transportation, we offer a free shuttle."

 **Answer: Free shuttle**

® **Rhetorical Questions**

If a speaker asks a **rhetorical question**, the next phrase contains the answer.

 Examples:

- *Didn't I tell you...? Haven't we already...?*

 Example in audio:

"Didn't I tell you the test starts at 9 AM?"

 **Answer: Test starts at 9 AM**

® Recognizing Synonyms & Paraphrasing

IELTS loves **paraphrasing**. The recording will **never** use the exact words from the question!

✅ Examples:

- *Cost* → *Price, Fee, Charge*
- *Job* → *Work, Occupation*

📌 **Example in audio:**

*Question: What is the **cost**?*

*Recording: "The **fee** is \$25."*

🔥 **Answer: \$25**

® Listening for Stressed Words

Speakers **naturally stress** important words.

📌 **Example in audio:**

*"You **MUST** return the book by **FRIDAY**."*

🔥 **Answer: Deadline – Friday**

® Spelling Out Answers

When speakers **spell names** or **numbers**, listen carefully!

📌 **Example in audio:**

"My name is J-O-H-N-S-O-N."

🔥 **Answer: Johnson**

® Repeated Information

When something is **repeated**, it's important!

📌 **Example in audio:**

"The event starts at 7 PM. I repeat, 7 PM."

🔥 **Answer: 7 PM**

® Comparing Two Options

Speakers often mention **two choices, but only one is correct**.

📌 **Example in audio:**

"I was thinking of visiting London, but I chose Paris instead."

🔥 **Answer: Paris**

® Days, Dates & Times

Be extra careful when you hear **times or dates**.

📌 **Exo:**

"Your appointment is not on Tuesday, but Wednesday."

🔥 **Answer: Wednesday**

® Common Numbers & Prices

Numbers are easy to mishear, so double-check them!

📌 **Example in audio:**

"The train leaves at fifteen past three."

🔥 **Answer: 3:15**

® Units of Measurement

Measurements like **km, kg, cm, liters** are common.

📌 **Example in audio:**

"The car weighs 1,500 kilograms."

🔥 **Answer: 1,500 kg**

® Location Clues

Look for **prepositions** to help identify locations.

📌 **Example in audio:**
“The shop is next to the bank.”
🔥 **Answer: Next to the bank**

® **Distractors (Traps!)**

Speakers sometimes **say something, then correct it.**

📌 **Example in audio:**
“The meeting is at 4 PM—oh wait, sorry, it’s at 5 PM.”
🔥 **Answer: 5 PM**